

Where does the money actually come from?

900+ startups. One dataset. Five hard questions about who actually makes money — and why.

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Domain authority

Fame vs. money — they're not the same

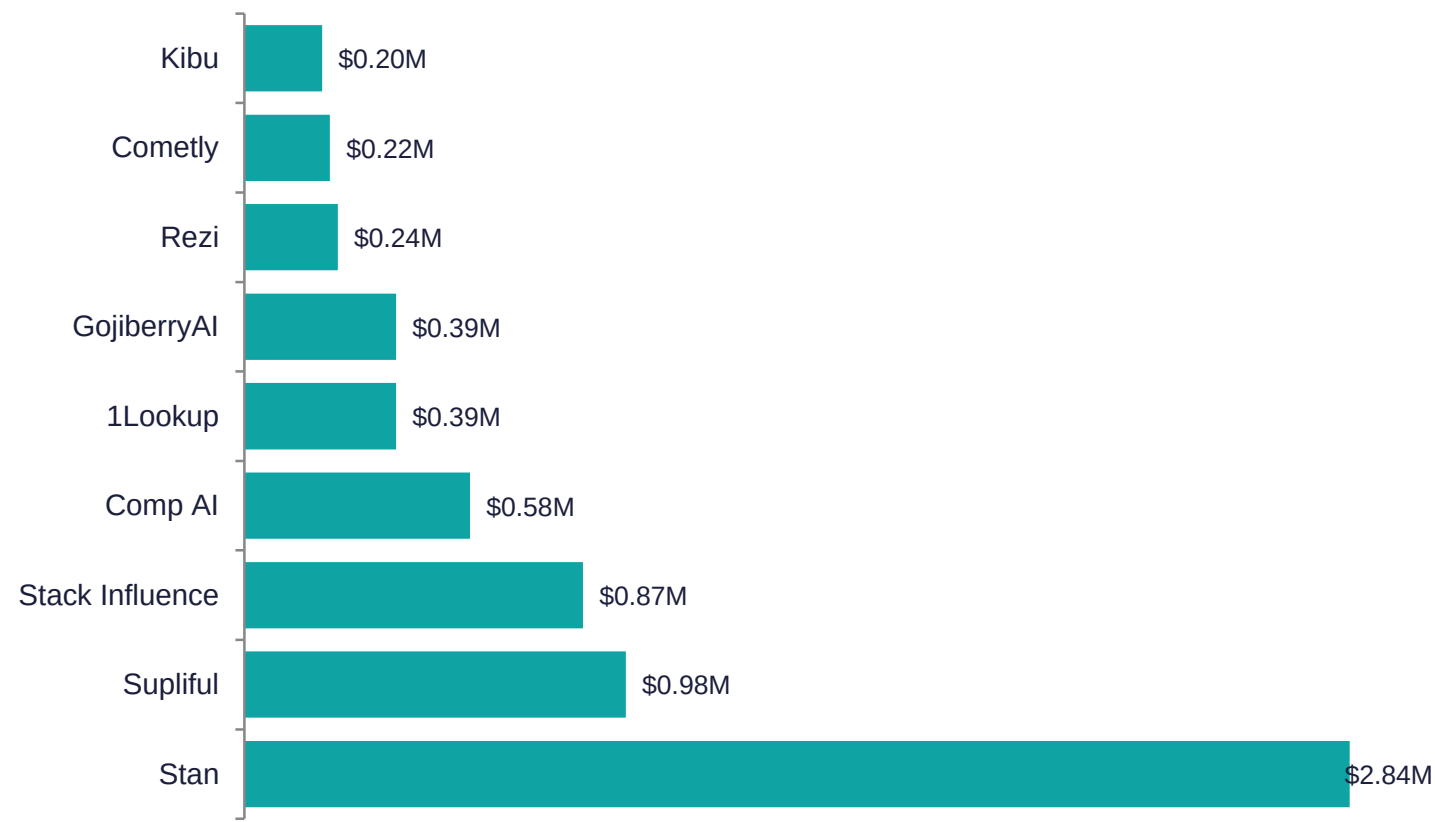
900+ startups analyzed

\$2.8M top single 30-day revenue

101K top active subscribers

A handful of companies dwarf everyone else

Ranking the top 30-day revenue earners in the dataset by category shows revenue is not spread evenly across the marketplace — it pools around a few outsized players in very different segments.



READ THIS FIRST

The #1 earner, Stan, is a B2C “link-in-bio” tool for creators — not an AI product, despite AI being the single most common category tag in the whole dataset.

Below it, revenue is dominated by B2B tools selling to businesses (compliance, fraud data, marketing services) — not by flashy AI apps.

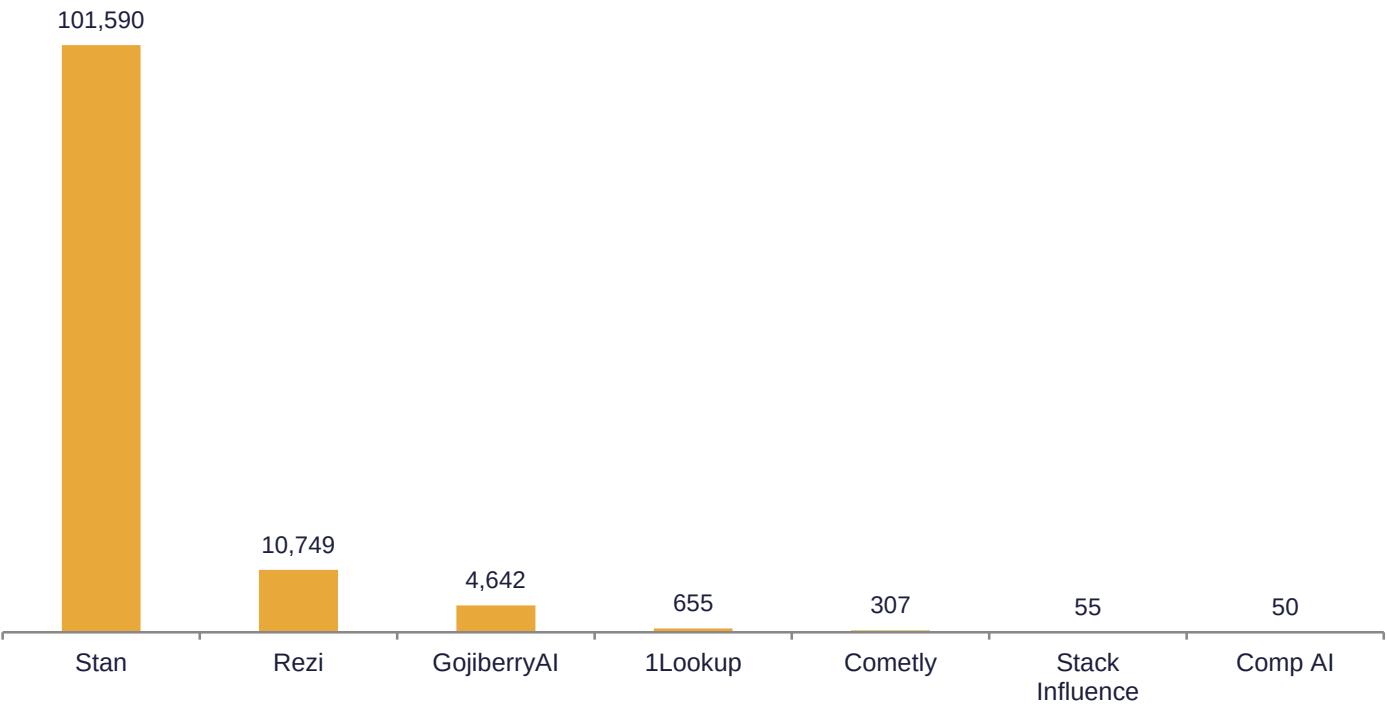
Takeaway: “AI” is the most crowded label, but it is not automatically the highest-earning one — the business model behind the label matters more than the label itself.

PART 2 — REVENUE VS. SUBSCRIBERS

The highest revenue does NOT mean the most subscribers

Pairing each top earner's 30-day revenue with its active subscription count reveals two completely different playbooks for making money.

Active subscriptions per company



APPROX. REVENUE PER USER (30-DAY)

Comp AI	~\$11,500 / account
Stack Influence	~\$15,800 / account
Kibu	~\$534 / account
GojiberryAI	~\$83 / user
Stan	~\$28 / user
Rezi	~\$23 / user

Enterprise B2B tools earn far more per account with a tiny customer base. Consumer tools earn far less per user but recruit tens of thousands of them.

Who they sell to explains the gap: B2B vs B2C

Of the top 8 revenue earners, 6 sell to businesses (B2B) and only 2 sell to individual consumers (B2C) — yet the B2C outlier, Stan, is still the single biggest earner because of massive scale.

B2B — SELL TO BUSINESSES

6 of top 8 earners • avg. revenue-per-account in the thousands

- Fewer, bigger checks: Comp AI, Stack Influence and Cometly close deals worth thousands, not dollars.
- Persona = decision-makers (compliance officers, marketing directors, sales leaders) who approve real budgets.
- Pricing is quote-based or flat monthly retainers, not self-serve — so revenue grows in large jumps.

B2C — SELL TO INDIVIDUALS

2 of top 8 earners • win only through volume

- Tiny checks, huge crowds: Stan (\$5–\$12/mo) and Rezi (freemium + \$29/mo) rely on six-figure user bases.
- Persona = individual creators and job seekers making small, low-friction, self-serve purchase decisions.
- Revenue climbs slowly with every new signup, so top-line size becomes a marketing and virality game, not a sales game.

Pricing model is the real revenue lever

Sliding from low-commitment, self-serve pricing to high-commitment, sales-led pricing trades subscriber volume for revenue per account. Both ends can win — but they win completely differently.



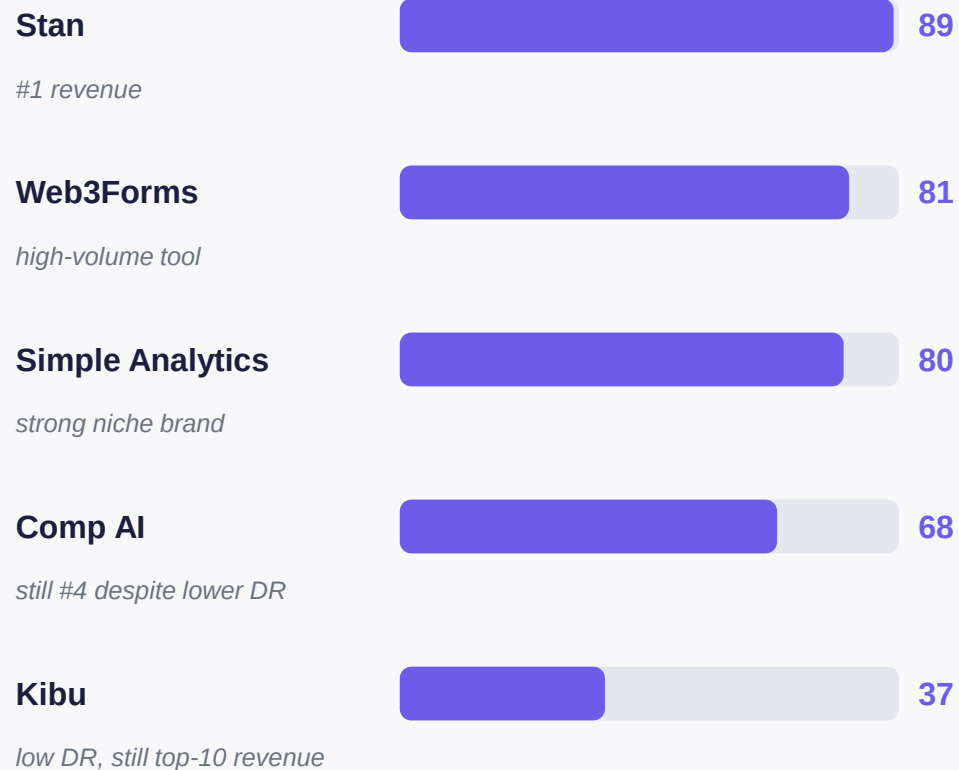
MORE SUBSCRIBERS, LOWER REVENUE-PER-USER

FEWER ACCOUNTS, MUCH HIGHER REVENUE-PER-ACCOUNT

Takeaway: moving one notch to the right on this slider (e.g. from freemium to usage-based) is consistently the biggest single driver of revenue-per-account in the dataset — bigger than category, follower count, or domain rating alone.

Domain rating helps get noticed — it doesn't guarantee revenue

DOMAIN RATING (DR) OF TOP EARNERS



MARKET-TAG CROWDING

“AI” is by far the most-used market tag across the whole dataset — hundreds of companies attach it. Yet AI-tagged companies range from \$0 to \$575K in 30-day revenue.

That spread means the tag itself carries almost no pricing power — it's the pricing model and buyer type layered on top (see Parts 3–4) that actually separates winners from the crowd.

Reading the two panels together:

- High DR (Stan, Web3Forms) correlates with high organic traffic — useful for volume, B2C-style plays.
- Low/medium DR companies (Comp AI, Kibu) still post top-tier revenue — because they sell, they don't just get found.
- Conclusion: DR amplifies a good pricing model; it cannot replace one.

THE BOTTOM LINE

Category doesn't make money. Pricing and buyer do.

01

Revenue is concentrated

A handful of companies out-earn hundreds of others combined.

02

“AI” isn't automatically richest

The #1 earner is creator commerce, not an AI product.

03

Users ≠ revenue

50 accounts can out-earn 100,000 users, and vice versa.

04

Pricing model wins

Freemium → usage → enterprise is the biggest lever we found.

05

Fame ≠ fortune

High domain rating drives traffic — not revenue by itself.

Before asking “what category are we in,” ask “who are we pricing this for — and how are we charging them.”